

CHRISTOPHER V. AYALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack technologist and cross-functional leader bridging engineering, product, and UX, well positioned at the intersection of business strategy, user experience, and scalable systems. Architected end-to-end production AI platforms, led strategic research programs driving executive roadmaps, and designed intuitive, high-impact interfaces. Backed by dual master's degrees (Software Development and HCI), translates fluidly between technical architecture reviews and user-discovery sessions to deliver measurable business results.

EXPERIENCE

Life360 (NASDAQ: LIF)

Senior AI Partner Engineer II (Forward Deployed Engineer)

San Mateo, CA

July 2026 – Present

- Lead 0-to-1 AI and automation development, partnering with cross-functional teams to transform ambiguous processes into robust, scalable, enterprise-grade intelligence systems.

DraftKings (NASDAQ: DKNG)

Senior Software Engineer, AI Platform Ops

Boston, MA

Jul 2025 – Jul 2026

- Own the AI Ops function for an internal AI platform powering 2,000+ dev and prod workflows, directing ~18K automated executions monthly (~1.13M + lifetime) across product, regulatory compliance, CX, and agent orchestration.
- Defined an enterprise governance framework for ~7,000 automations, including a FinOps algorithm for cost-benefit analysis. Managed multi-agent audits for 1,900+ processes, mitigating security risks like credential leaks to guide leadership strategy.
- Developed an autonomous AI code-review verdict subsystem (29 PRs) managing ~86K reviews for 700+ repos; patched security flaws to verify check execution before honoring verdicts.
- Orchestrated AI SDLC execution for 23 epics and resolved 414 tickets with an 80% resolution rate within one week.

Senior Product Researcher, Platform

Jul 2022 – Jul 2025

- Championed the "My Stat Sheet" feature from behavioral and risk insight to launch, driving adoption across 13M+ users and 30% engagement in year one.
- Directed research programs (MaxDiff, CSAT, mixed-methods) across platform health, deposits, and responsible gaming, shaping VP-level roadmap decisions with the findings.
- Aligned Engineering, Design, and Product teams around requirements traceability and evidence-based decision-making across the full product lifecycle.

U.S. Bancorp (NYSE: USB)

Product (UX) Researcher, Assistant Vice President (AVP)

Minneapolis, MN

Dec 2021 – Aug 2022

- Established a continuous product-intelligence workflow built on session replays and quantified behavioral signals, accelerating decision-making for teams shipping customer-facing financial tools.

Freelance

UX Designer

Minneapolis, MN

Jan 2021 – Aug 2021

- Led the redesign of digital experiences for venues and SMBs, translating multi-method research into technical specs that drove a 46% increase in patient bookings and optimized flow for 20K+ monthly visitors.

EDUCATION

Boston University

Master of Science in Software Development - GPA 3.69

Boston, MA

Jul 2023 - Jan 2025

DePaul University

Master of Science with Distinction in Human Computer Interaction - GPA 3.93

Chicago, IL

Jul 2020 - Dec 2021

SKILLS

AI & Automation: LLMs, RAG, vector databases, agent orchestration, evals, LangChain, LangGraph, OpenAI, Anthropic, n8n

Engineering & Infrastructure: Python, TypeScript, SQL, Java, Bash, AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, vector databases

Leadership & Delivery: Stakeholder management, technical scoping, solution architecture, deployment ownership, user onboarding, cross-functional delivery